Root Cause Analysis (5 Whys) Template · Beginner version

A root cause analysis template guides you from a problem to its underlying cause using the 5 whys, then to corrective actions with owners, so the problem does not come back.

5 whys · Keep asking why until you reach a cause you can fix

Step	Question	Answer
Problem	What happened, where, when and how much?	Release 2.3 was delayed by 9 days
Why 1	Why did it happen?	Testing started late
Why 2	Why?	The test environment was not ready
Why 3	Why?	Environment requests were raised two days before testing
Why 4	Why?	Environment needs are not part of sprint planning
Why 5	Why?	There is no checklist for release prerequisites
Root cause	Summarise the root cause	No release prerequisites checklist in planning